

Schedule

PS50008A Research Methods | Term 2 Spring 2026

Gordon Wright

20 January 2026

Term 2 Schedule

Term Dates

- **Term Start:** Monday 12 January 2026
- **Reading Week:** 16-20 February 2026
- **Term End:** Friday 27 March 2026

Weekly Overview

Week	Dates	Topic	Lecture	Lab	Assessment
11	12-16 Jan	DataLab	None	Data-Lab	
12	19-23 Jan	Distributions & Variability	Yes	De-scriptives in R	
13	26-30 Jan	Building Your Re-search	Yes	Re-search Plan Workshop	
14	2-6 Feb	Is Your Effect Real?	Yes	t-tests in R	
15	9-13 Feb	Correlation	Yes	Correlation in R	

Week	Dates	Topic	Lecture	Lab	Assessment
—	16-20 Feb	Reading Week	—	—	Work on Research Plan
16	23-27 Feb	Regression	Yes	Project groups	Research Plan due Fri 27 Feb
17	2-6 Mar	Interpretation & Credibility	Yes	Project groups	
18	9-13 Mar	MCQ Exam	MCQ Exam	Project groups	MCQ Exam Mon 9 Mar
19	16-20 Mar	Project Workshop	Yes	Project groups	EDS due Fri 20 Mar
20	23-27 Mar	Wrapping Up	Yes	Report writing	

Session Times

Session	Day	Time	Location
Lecture	Wednesday	10:00-12:00	RHBD 143
Lab Group A	Thursday	10:00-12:00	WB 304a
Lab Group B	Thursday	10:00-12:00	Wb 304b

Week 11 Note

There is no lecture in Week 11 due to employability events.

Assessment Deadlines

Assessment	Weight	Deadline	Week
Research Plan	20%	Friday 27 February 2026, 12 noon	16
MCQ Exam	20%	Monday 9 March 2026, in lecture slot	18
EDS Assignment	20%	Friday 20 March 2026, 12 noon	20
Research Report	40%	Friday 1 May 2026, 12 noon	Post-term

Week-by-Week Detail

First Half: Building Skills (Weeks 11-15)

Week 11: DataLab

- Generate the dataset you'll use all term
- Form your project groups
- No lecture

Week 12: Distributions & Variability

- First lecture (2 hours)
- Mean, median, mode, standard deviation
- Introduction to R for descriptives
- *Report writing: Descriptive statistics*

Week 13: Building Your Research

- Operationalising variables (with real paper examples)
- Writing hypotheses (one-tailed vs two-tailed)
- Design decisions and trade-offs
- Connecting design to statistical tests
- *Assessment focus: Research Plan preparation*

Week 14: Is Your Effect Real?

- Null hypothesis significance testing
- p-values and significance
- Confidence intervals and effect sizes (Cohen's d)
- Independent vs paired t-tests
- Complete APA reporting
- *Report writing: t-test results with CIs and effect sizes*

Week 15: Correlation

- Scatterplots and relationships
- Pearson vs Spearman
- Correlation $\neq$ causation
- Last week before Reading Week
- *Report writing: Correlation results*

Reading Week

- Work on your Research Plan (due Week 16)
- Review material for MCQ (Week 18)
- No taught sessions

Second Half: Application & Assessment (Weeks 16-20)

Week 16: Regression

- **Research Plan due Friday**
- From correlation to prediction
- Line of best fit
- Labs now in project groups
- *Report writing: Methods section*

Week 17: Interpretation & Credibility

- P-hacking and HARKing
- Replication crisis
- MCQ prep in lecture
- *Report writing: Introduction section*

Week 18: MCQ Exam

- **MCQ Exam Monday (in lecture slot)**
- Lab is project support
- *Report writing: Introduction continued*

Week 19: Project Workshop

- APA results reporting
- Project analysis support
- EDS preview
- *Report writing: Discussion preview*

Week 20: Wrapping Up

- **EDS Assignment due Friday**
- Lecture: Project data showcase, lab report structure, discussion sections
- Lab: Final analysis support and report writing
- *Report writing: Discussion section — interpreting findings, limitations, implications*

Key Dates Summary

Jan 12-16	Week 11: DataLab (first contact)
Jan 19-23	Week 12: First lecture
Feb 13	Last day before Reading Week
Feb 16-20	Reading Week
Feb 27	Research Plan due (noon)
Mar 11	MCQ Exam (lecture slot)
Mar 20	EDS Assignment due (noon)
May 1	Research Report due (noon)